

General Internal Medicine

Buzzword Quick Reference

Depressed mood + anhedonia (>2 weeks)

Dx: Major depressive disorder (SIGECAPS)

Next: SSRI (e.g., sertraline); screen for bipolar.

Mania (>1 week) vs hypomania (>4 days)

Dx: Bipolar I vs bipolar II

Next: Mood stabilizer (lithium/valproate).

Dilated pupils + hyperreflexia + clonus

Dx: Serotonin syndrome

Next: Stop offending agent; Cyproheptadine.

Lead-pipe rigidity + high fever + CK

Dx: Neuroleptic malignant syndrome

Next: Stop antipsychotic; Dantrolene or Bromocriptine.

Hypertensive crisis after cheese/wine

Dx: MAOI tyramine reaction

Next: Phentolamine.

Confusion + ataxia + ophthalmoplegia

Dx: Wernicke encephalopathy

Next: Thiamine BEFORE glucose.

Pinpoint pupils + respiratory depression

Dx: Opioid overdose

Next: Naloxone.

Alcohol withdrawal + autonomic instability

Dx: Delirium tremens (48–96h)

Next: Benzodiazepines (lorazepam).

Other Psychiatric Disorders

- **Eating Disorders: Anorexia nervosa:** BMI <18.5 with fear of weight gain. Risk: **refeeding syndrome** (hypophosphatemia → arrhythmias). **Bulimia nervosa:** Binge/purge; parotid enlargement, enamel erosion, hypokalemia; Tx: SSRI.
- **OCD:** Obsessions + compulsions. Tx: High-dose SSRI + CBT (exposure/response prevention).

Biostatistics

- **Incidence:** Number of new cases in a population over a time period.
- **Prevalence:** Total number of cases (new + old) in a population at a single point in time.
- **Sensitivity:** proportion of patients with disease who test positive (SnNout: a highly sensitive test, when negative, helps rule out disease). Use high-sensitivity tests for screening when missing cases is costly.
- **Specificity:** Ability to correctly identify those WITHOUT the disease (SpIN). Use for confirmation.
- **Positive Predictive Value (PPV):** $P(\text{disease} \mid +\text{test})$. Increases with prevalence.
- **TRAP:** In low-prevalence populations, even good tests yield many **false positives**.
- **Negative Predictive Value (NPV):** Probability that a person with a negative test truly lacks the disease. Decreases with prevalence.
- **Number Needed to Treat (NNT):** $1 / \text{Absolute Risk Reduction (ARR)}$.
ARR = Control Event Rate - Experimental Event Rate.
- **Confidence Interval (CI):** If the 95% CI for a ratio (OR, RR) does not include 1, or for a difference does not include 0, the result is statistically significant.